



CUTTER ABOVE THE REST

The humble off-cutter emerged as the most **potent weapon** for fast bowlers this T20 World Cup.

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The off-cutter is often the first bowling variation acquired by up-and-coming pacers across the world. At a practical level, it is usually an easier skill to learn and execute than its slow-ball counterparts, such as the leg-cutter or the knuckleball.

This may be down to the simplicity of an off-cutter's execution. Conceptually, it is delivered by 'cutting' the ball across the seam clockwise upon release, forcing it to move into a right-handed batter after bouncing.

Despite its effective simplicity and perceived ordinariness, the humble off-cutter emerged as one of the primary wicket-taking tools for fast bowlers this T20 World Cup.

Of the 357 wickets claimed by the quicks at the tournament, 68 were taken using the off-cutter. This is, by some distance, the most wickets secured using this ball type in a single edition of the tournament.

There were 795 off-cutters at the 2026 T20 World Cup, a significant jump from the previous highest in an edition — 485 (2016).

Predictably, the off-cutters were more effective against the southpaws. In this edition, against this delivery type, left-handed batters averaged 14.03. The corresponding figure for the righties was 21.14.

Though it reaped bucketloads of wickets, the off-cutter also proved to be a risk-heavy option for the pacers. The economy for such deliveries in the tournament was 9.39, the highest ever in a single edition.

Much like almost all of the options available to a bowler, the off-cutter is heavily condition-dependent. In